

Cognitive Functions

Cognitive functions are the technical term for “Modes of processing information and making decisions based on your Myers-Briggs type.” Each type has four (out of a possible eight) cognitive functions, which they use in a specific order. Identifying which functions you use – and in what order – is the most accurate way to type yourself or anyone else.

ENFJ Functions ENFJ Primary Processes

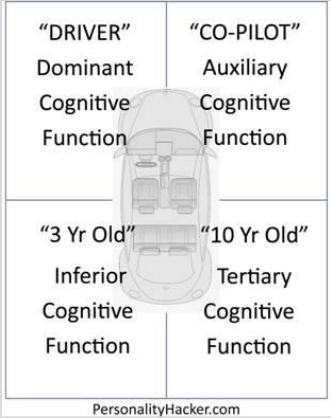
The inner world (introversion)

The outer world (extroversion)

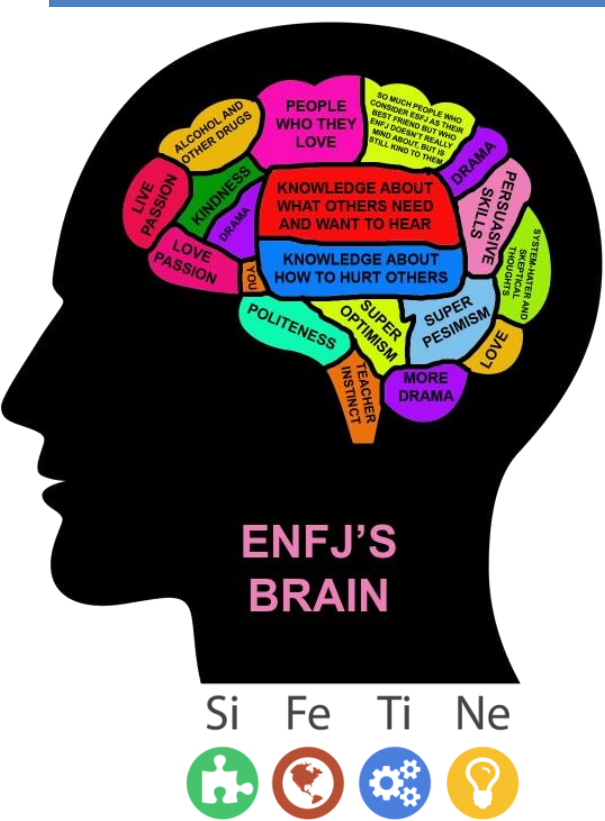
Role	Process	Snapshot
Leading “Driver”	Extroverted Feeling	Connecting and considering others and the group.
Supportive “Co-Pilot”	Introverted iNtuition	Foreseeing implications, transformations, and likely effects.
Relief “10 year old”	Extroverted Sensing	Experiencing and acting in the immediate context.
Aspirational “3 year old”	Introverted Thinking	Analysing, categorising, and evaluating according to principles.

The analogy of a car is a useful model when thinking about cognitive functions. The first function is the 'driver' of the personality type and is the function from which perspective of all of the other functions follow. It provides the direction and speed. The second function is the 'co-pilot', which navigates around or through any difficulties encountered. The inferior, or 3 year old, function attempts to distract both primary and secondary functions whereas the tertiary function, or '10 year old', only distracts the current dominant function.

Understanding cognitive functions is imperative to understanding type. The four-letter dichotomies cannot possibly explain the complexity of our personalities – we are all thinkers, feelers, sensors and intuitives in various situations. The cognitive functions allow us to understand when we use each function and how it impacts our decision-making process.



The Cognitive Functions



Role	Process	Snapshot
Ne	Extroverted Intuition	How do concepts happen outside me?
Ni	Introverted Intuition	How do concepts happen within me?
Fe	Extroverted Feeling	How does this make others feel?
Fi	Introverted Feeling	Experiencing and acting in the immediate context.
Te	Extroverted Thinking	How does this logically affect things?
Ti	Introverted Thinking	How does this logically affect me?
Se	Extroverted Sensing	How is the environment outside me?
Si	Introverted Sensing	How is the environment inside me?

CONCLUSION

ENFJ Mentors value honesty, openness and understanding in their relationships.

Their greatest contribution is their ability to throw all their energies into developing others and making a lasting difference in people's lives.



What is MBTI?

Myers-Briggs Type Indicator (MBTI) is a tool that helps people gain insights about themselves and how they interact with others—and improve how they communicate, learn, and work.

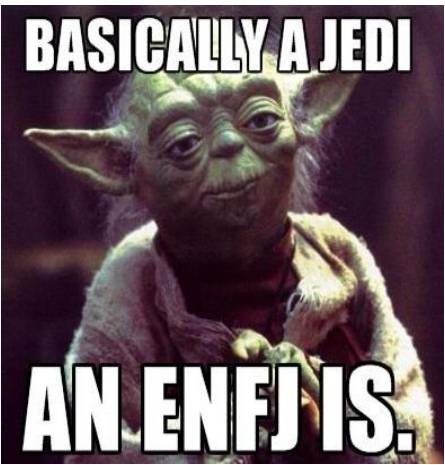
Often referred to as a 'personality test', MBTI actually has less to do with one's personality and everything to do with how their brain works from receiving and processing external information to communication preferences. These preferences are split into four pairs – I/E, S/N, F/T and J/P. Though everyone is unique and will have some traits of all 8 letters, people will often be more inclined towards one letter in each pair. By determining your preference in each group, and putting these four letters together, you get your personality type code – for you, this is ENFJ.

ENFJ – The Mentor

What does that mean?

- Extroverted Energised by time with others
- iNtuition Focus on ideas and concepts
- Feeling Prioritises people and emotions
- Judging Prefers structure and order

ENFJs are idealist organisers, driven to implement their vision of what is best for humanity. They often act as catalysts for human growth because of their ability to see potential in other people and their charisma in persuading others to their ideas. They are focused on values and vision, and are passionate about the possibilities for people.



ENFJs are typically energetic and driven, and often have a lot on their plates. They are tuned into the needs of others and acutely aware of human suffering; however, they also tend to be optimistic and forward-thinking, intuitively seeing opportunity for improvement. The ENFJ is ambitious, but their ambition is not self-serving: rather, they feel personally responsible for making the world a better place.

ENFJs are driven by a deep sense of altruism and empathy for other people. They have an intuitive sense of the emotions of others, and often act as an emotional barometer for the people around them. However, their compassion not reserved for the people close to them: they are often humanitarian in nature, and may feel genuine concern for the ills of the entire human race. They tend to personally experience the feelings of others, and feel compelled to act when they see people suffering.

ENFJs are natural-born leaders, full of passion and charisma. They are oftentimes our politicians, our coaches and our teachers, reaching out and inspiring others to achieve and to do good in the world. With a natural confidence that begets influence, ENFJs take a great deal of pride and joy in guiding others to work together to improve themselves and their community.

Strengths

- Tolerant** – ENFJs are true team players, and they recognise that that means listening to other peoples' opinions, even when they contradict their own.
- Reliable** – If it's possible, ENFJs can always be counted on to see it through.
- Charismatic** – Charm and popularity are qualities ENFJs have in spades. They instinctively know how to capture an audience, and pick up on mood and motivation in ways that allow them to communicate with reason, emotion, passion, restraint – whatever the situation calls for.
- Altruistic** – ENFJs' have an unyielding desire to do good in and for their communities, be it in their own home or the global stage. Warm and selfless, ENFJs genuinely believe that if they can just bring people together, they can do a world of good.
- Natural Leaders** – More than seeking authority themselves, ENFJs often end up in leadership roles at the request of others, cheered on by the many admirers of their strong personality and positive vision.

Weaknesses

- Overly Idealistic** – ENFJs can be caught off guard as they find that people fight against them and defy the principles they've adopted, however well-intentioned they may be.
- Too Selfless** – ENFJs can bury themselves in their hopeful promises, feeling others' problems as their own and striving hard to meet their word.
- Too Sensitive** – While receptive to criticism, seeing it as a tool for leading a better team, it's easy for ENFJs to take it a little too much to heart.
- Fluctuating Self-Esteem** – ENFJs define their self-esteem by whether they are able to live up to their ideals, and sometimes ask for criticism more out of insecurity than out of confidence, always wondering what they could do better.
- Struggle to Make Tough Decisions** – If caught between a rock and a hard place, ENFJs can be stricken with paralysis, imagining all the consequences of their actions, especially if those consequences are humanitarian.



Recognising the ENFJ

ENFJs are natural teachers, often found organising people to take part in some educational activity. They tend to take charge of a situation, and guide a group towards those activities and experiences which will help them learn and grow. They intuitively see the potential in people, and with charisma and warmth, they encourage others to pursue greater development of their strengths. They are typically dynamic and productive, and are often visibly energised when leading others to discover new knowledge.

ENFJs are typically good communicators, talented at using words to connect with others. They are perceptive about people and enjoy talking about relationships. They often enjoy helping others solve personal problems and like to share their insights about people, their emotions, and their motivations. They are empathetic sometimes to the point of being overinvolved, and can become exhausted if they are surrounded by too much negative emotion.



Career

ENFJs thrive when they are in a position to help others. They do well in environments that provide meaningful interaction and very little conflict. They get bored when the job involves too many details or paperwork. They are natural teachers and counsellors. They work with enthusiasm and order.

As subordinates: ENFJs will often underestimate themselves – nevertheless, they quickly make an impression on their managers. Quick learners and excellent multitaskers, people with the ENFJ personality type are able to take on multiple responsibilities with competence and good cheer. ENFJs are hardworking, reliable and eager to help. They are conflict-averse and try to avoid unnecessary criticism.

As colleagues: ENFJs' desire to assist and cooperate is even more evident as they draw their co-workers into teams where everyone can feel comfortable expressing their opinions and suggestions, working together to develop win-win situations that get the job done. Their tolerance, open-mindedness and easy sociability make it easy for them to relate to their colleagues, but also make it perhaps a little too easy for their colleagues to shift their problems onto ENFJs' plates.

As managers: ENFJs' true calling, where their capacity for insightful and inspiring communication and sensitivity to the needs of others really shows, is in managing teams. As managers, ENFJs combine their skill in recognising individual motivations with their natural charisma to not only push their teams and projects forward, but to make their teams want to push forward.

Career Matches

- Teacher/Professor
- Social Worker
- Career Counsellor
- Counsellor
- Therapist
- Psychologist
- Psychiatrist
- Trainer
- Human Resources
- Librarian
- Writer
- Nurse
- Diplomat
- Consultant
- Artist
- Editor
- Administrator
- Actor/Actress
- Events Coordinator
- Facilitator
- Homemaker
- Musician
- Designer
- Engineer
- Occupational Therapist
- Politician
- Project Manager
- Sales Agent
- Senior Manager

Popular ENFJ hobbies

- Organising social events
- Reading
- The arts
- Museums
- Storytelling
- Listening to music
- Writing
- Gourmet cooking



Relationships

Relationships are the centrepiece in the Mentor's life. Everything they do revolves around establishing a meaningful connection. Their greatest desire is to praise, nurture and understand. They are very protective of the people they love. They enjoy spending time with people and possess the ability to bring out the very best in others. ENFJs inspire others to learn, develop and grow. They seek reconciliation and healing in conflict situations

In relationships, the ENFJ is helpful and enthusiastically supportive. They are motivated to understand their partners and to do what pleases them, and are sensitive the emotions and reactions of their mates. They make great cheerleaders, and will encourage their partners to develop and explore their potential. They are engaged and ready to help, and look for opportunities to support their mates in their accomplishments.

Kindred spirits:

INFJ, ESFJ, ENFP

Intriguing differences:

INTJ, INFP, ENTP, ENTJ

ISFJ, INTP, ESTJ and ESFP personalities can clash and conflict with the ENFJ, but may also offer the best opportunities for growth. With fundamentally different values and motivations, their strengths are the ENFJ's weaknesses, and if they are able to develop a relationship, they can learn a tremendous amount from each other.



Burnout

ENFJs will become burnt out and overwhelmed if:

- they neglect their own needs in order to tend to the needs of others.
- goes too long without having any help or appreciation from those around them

ENFJs are mainly focused on taking care of their loved ones, and will do anything to make them happy. They are extremely people focused, and because of this they will likely ignore their own emotions for a long period of time. They try to handle far too many tasks all by themselves, and eventually this becomes hard to handle.

The ENFJ will become less capable of being around others, and might lose their compassionate nature. They will be much less considerate, and might even snap at the people they love. They often need their loved ones to comfort them and show them just how much they appreciate their efforts. They also need time to rest and take care of their own needs and desires in order to get back to normal.



ENFJ Stressors



Change

ENFJs like to keep their life organised, they enjoy being able to foresee what is to come. The ENFJ wants to be able to keep harmony in their environment and works very hard to maintain balance. When things become too disarrayed or altered, the ENFJ will become extremely stressed. They work very hard to make sure that everything in their lives is figured out and taken care of. If things become too much of a mess the ENFJ may not be able to take care of their loved ones, that is simply unacceptable. Making others happy is extremely important to the ENFJ, this is why they want to keep everything in order. Change could mean bad things for their loved ones, so the ENFJ definitely does not appreciate that.

Famous ENFJs

- King David, *King of Israel*
- Abraham Maslow, *Psychologist*
- Francois Mitterand, *French President*
- Dick Van Dyke, *Actor*
- Peyton Manning, *NFL Quarterback*
- Tommy Lee Jones, *Actor*
- Pete Sampras, *Tennis Champion*
- Ralph Nader, *Attorney, Political Activist*
- Martin Luther King, Jr., *Minister, Civil Rights Activist*

Fictional ENFJs

- Bilbo Baggins, *Lord of the Rings*
- Danny Tanner, *Full House*
- Jules Winnfield, *Pulp Fiction*
- Captain Archer, *Star Trek: Enterprise*
- Catherine, *Wuthering Heights*
- Charlotte, *Charlotte's Web*
- Neil, *Dead Poets Society*

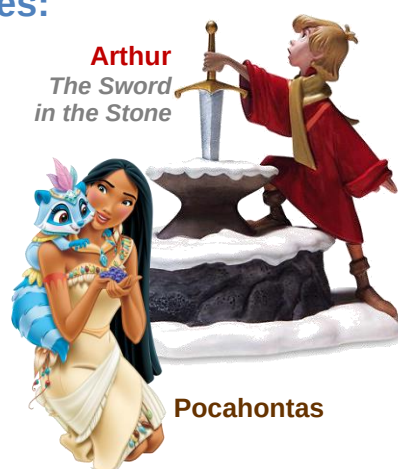
Your character matches:

Game of Thrones:



Jon Snow
Night's Watch

Disney:



Pocahontas

What makes ENFJs happy?

- Successfully making their loved ones happy.
- When they have provided for their family and friends completely.
- Feeling loved and appreciated by the people around them.
- People who are patient with them, and aren't overly demanding.
- When the people they love want to spend quality time with them.
- When others actively seek their affection and approval.
- When someone truly listens and allows them to vent and express themselves.

